



Sports Highlights on Digital

2025

India Edition

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1.

Sports in the Digital Landscape

Sports on Digital: **Industry Size**

Worldwide* Sports Audience

668M

Unique visitors

Worldwide* Sports %Reach

37%

Reach

Source: Comscore MMX Multi-Platform, Total Audience, Desktop and Mobile, Sports, June2025, Worldwide Rollup*

*Worldwide Rollup represents the summation of the following individually reportable Mobile Metrix and MMX Multi-Platform geographies: United States, Canada, Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Finland, France, Germany, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, Mexico, Norway, Singapore, Spain, Taiwan, United Kingdom and Vietnam.

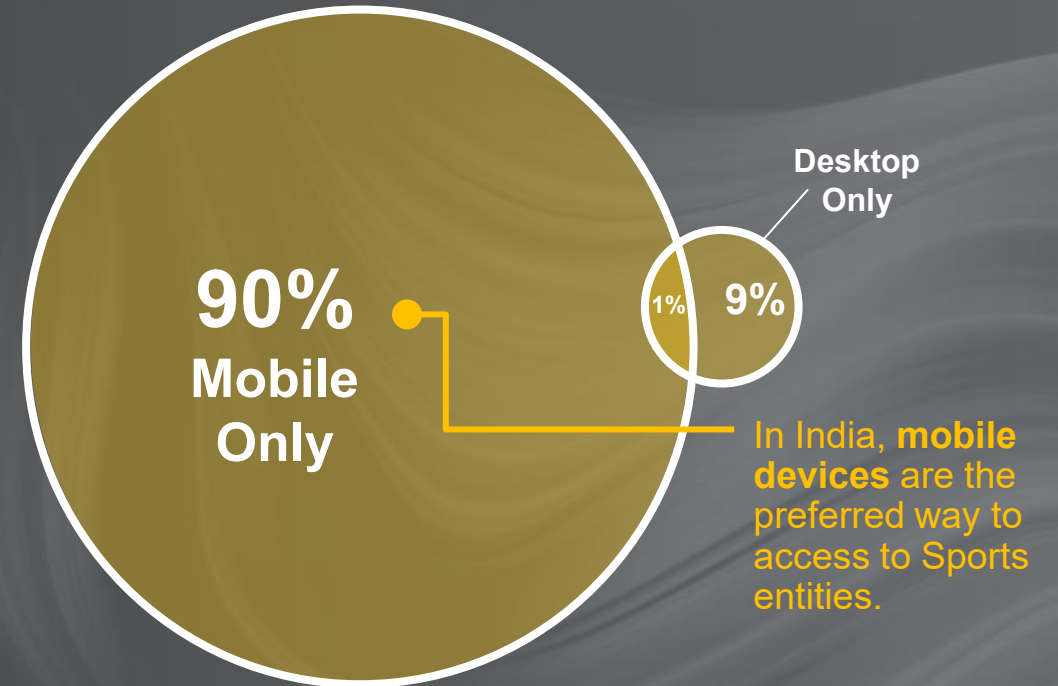
Sports Entities Digital Audience in India

Sports Category Desktop & Mobile Audience

118M

Unique visitors

Sports Category Audience Distribution by Platforms



Sports Digital Audience **Other Interest Areas in India**

Sports audiences are also present in other categories, such as Gaming, which shares 70% of unique visitors – one of the most significant overlaps.

Gaming



70%

Technology



67%

Travel



58%

Health

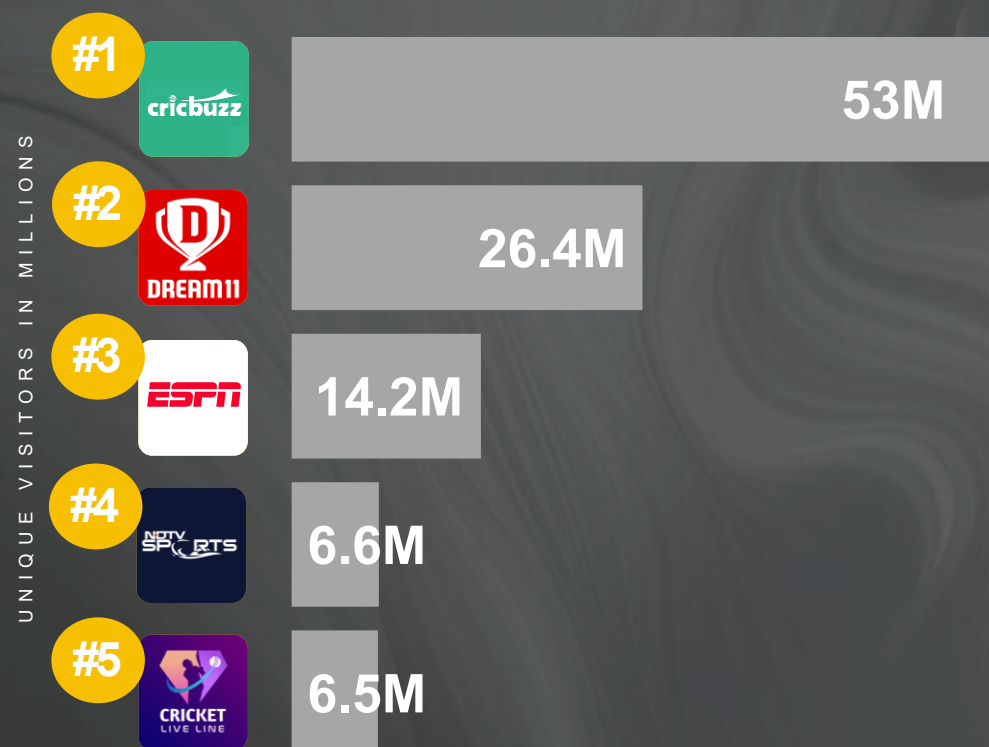


31%

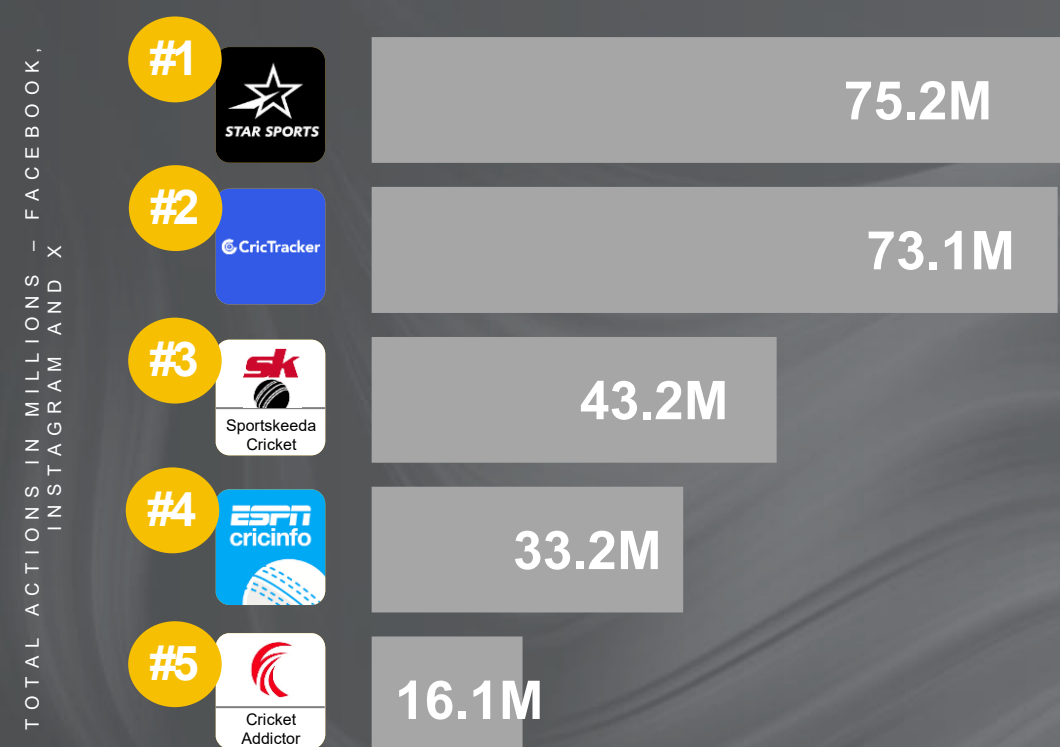
Top Sports Publishers Outlook in India

Cricbuzz led in Desktop & mobile audience with 53 million unique visitors, while Star Sports ranked highest in social engagement.

Sports Publishers on Desktop & Mobile by Audience



Sports Publications & Websites on Social Media by Engagement



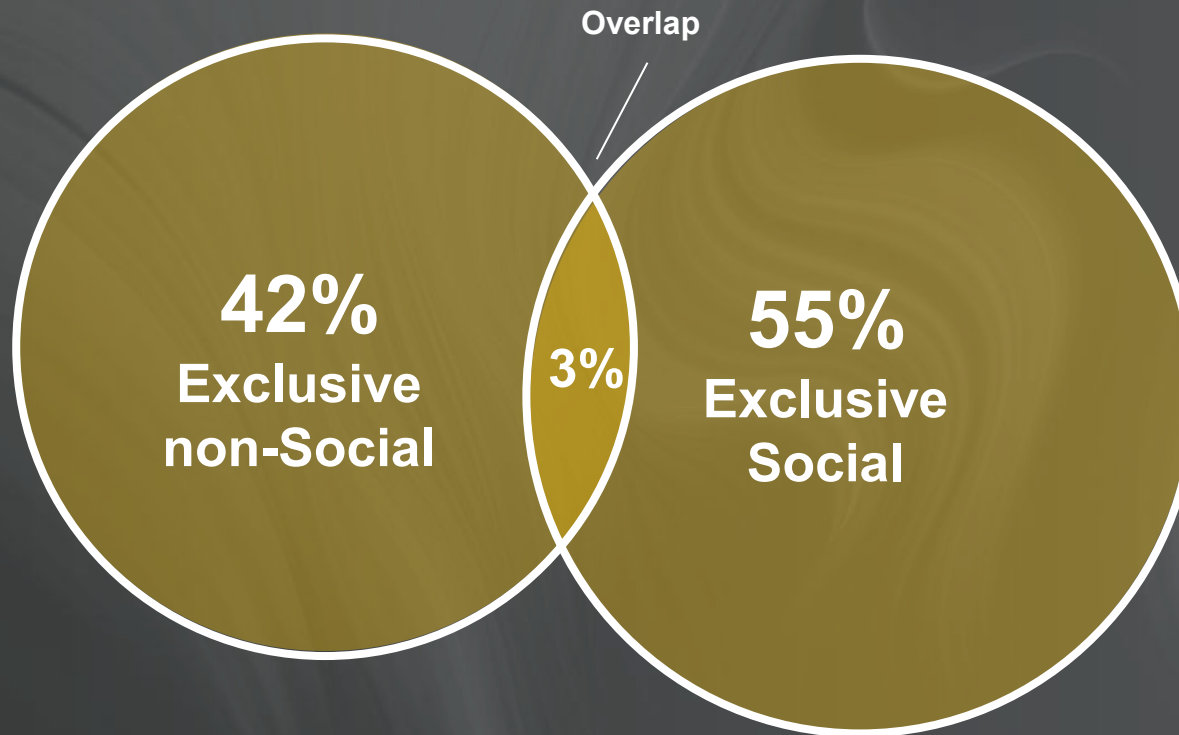
Source: Comscore MMX Multi-Platform, Desktop & Mobile, Total Audience, Sports, June 2025, India.

Source: Comscore Social, Power Rankings, Platforms: Facebook, Instagram and X, Sports IN* Publications & Websites and Media & Entertainment, June 2025.

Note: "Actions" refers to interactions including reactions, comments, shares, reposts, likes and hearts.

The Scale of Sports Consumption

Sports Social Incremental India Audiences Breakdown – %Composition Unique Visitors



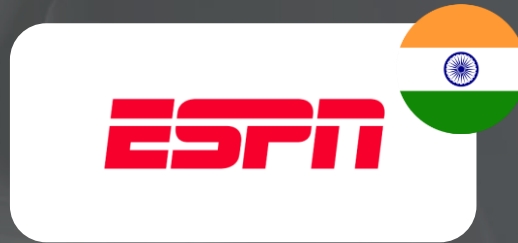
Sports content shows the strong role of Social Media as access point in India.

Brands and media may look to expand reach by adopting a dual-channel strategy, leveraging both social and non-social touchpoints to effectively capture diverse Sports audience segments.

ESPN India: Social Incremental Audiences Breakdown

ESPN's audience profile in India illustrates the overwhelming dominance of social platforms in driving reach, highlighting the platform's role not only as a traffic generator, but as the brand's primary distribution ecosystem.

Social Incremental India Audience Breakdown – Unique Visitors



Desktop & Mobile

14.2M

Social

+ 25.4M =

TOTAL DIGITAL
POPULATION (TDP)
Deduplicated*

36.9M

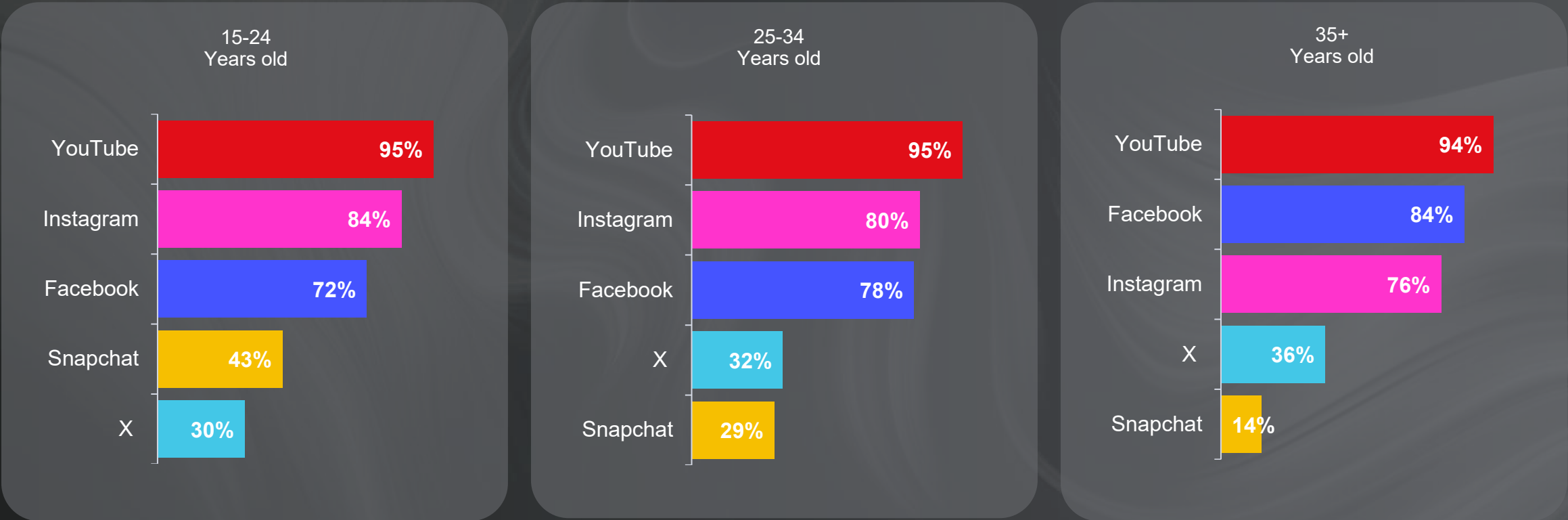
2.

Social Platforms as Key Players

Sports & Social Platform Shared Audience by Age

YouTube is the preferred platform across all Indian sports audiences age groups. However, 15-34 shows preference for Instagram, while those aged 35+ lean towards Facebook.

Sports India Unique Visitors
%Shared Audience by Social Platform, Desktop & Mobile - Web & Apps



Source: Comscore Multi-Platform, Desktop & Mobile, Cross Visiting, Audience: 15-24, 25-34 and 35+, Sports, Selected entities: [M] YouTube, [M] INSTAGRAM.COM, [C] FACEBOOK.COM, [[P] Snapchat, Inc, and [M] X.COM, June 2025, India.

Sports Brands Engagement on Social Media

Sports & Recreation content is one of the top drivers of engagement in the Indian social media landscape with cricket brands generating the highest engagement rates per post.

Sports & Recreation brands handles
represent the

20%

of engagement in the Indian
social media landscape.

Indian Sports & Recreation Brands on Social Media by Engagement per Post

AVERAGE TOTAL ACTIONS PER POST IN
THOUSANDS - FACEBOOK, INSTAGRAM AND X



Source: Comscore Social, Power Ranking, across Facebook, Instagram and X, IIN*Sports & Recreation, June 2025.

Note: "Actions" refers to interactions including reactions, comments, shares, reposts, likes and hearts.

Athletes Impact on Social Media

Sports personalities embrace their social influencer status. This underscores the strategic value of athlete-led content in driving visibility and fan interaction.

Instagram engagement with Indian athlete profiles rose by

+56%

during H1 2025.

Indian Athletes Impact on Social Media

AVERAGE TOTAL ACTIONS PER POST IN
MILLIONS – FACEBOOK, INSTAGRAM AND X



2.6M
TOTAL
ACTIONS/POST



1.9M
TOTAL
ACTIONS/POST



1.6M
TOTAL
ACTIONS/POST

Stay Up to Date with the **Weekly Social Scorecard**

The weekly dashboard featuring the Indian brands & influencers social media engagement pulse, where the sports industry often ranks among the top performers.

Date: 13 to 19 October, 2025

Top content of the week across social platforms

Channel	Brand	Total actions*
Instagram	Shubman Gill	6,116,354
Facebook	T-Series Bhakti Sagar	1,124,665
X	Virat Kohli	339,370
YouTube		

*Numbers might grow over time

India's top brands of the week

#	Brand	Total actions*
1	InstantBollywood	36,316,808
2	Indian Cricket Team	35,902,778
3	Aaj Tak	21,554,889
4	RVCJ Media	19,532,968
5	Royal Challengers Bangalore	17,943,682

India's top influencers of the week

#	Influencer	Total actions*
1	PM Narendra Modi	10,635,564
2	Shubman Gill	7,232,805
3	Rashmika Mandanna	6,688,373
4	Yo Yo Honey Singh	5,456,438
5		

India's top sponsor of the week

#	Top sponsor	Who they sponsored	Total actions*
1	TCL Electronics India	Rohit Sharma	625,825
2	Ching's Secret	Ranveer Singh	584,136
3	Vivo India	Sidharth Malhotra	125,633



Click or scan the QR
code for free access to
all **latest week's data!**

3.

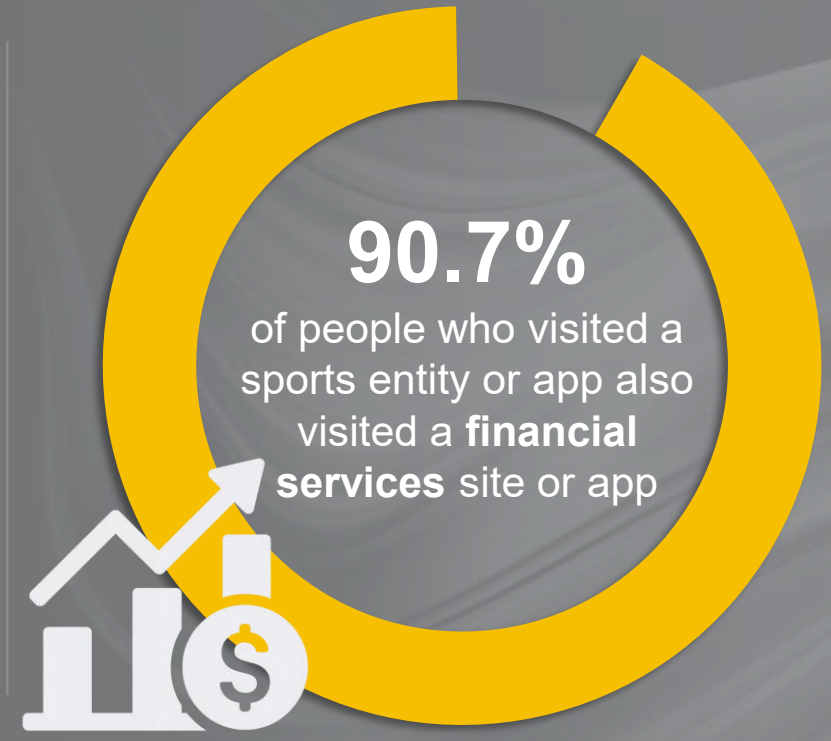
Partnerships that Score

Sports Fans and **Key Advertiser Categories Shared Audiences**

Sports audiences are 25% more likely than the general population to visit retail and financial services sites in India.

Sports Shared Audiences with Retail and Financial Services

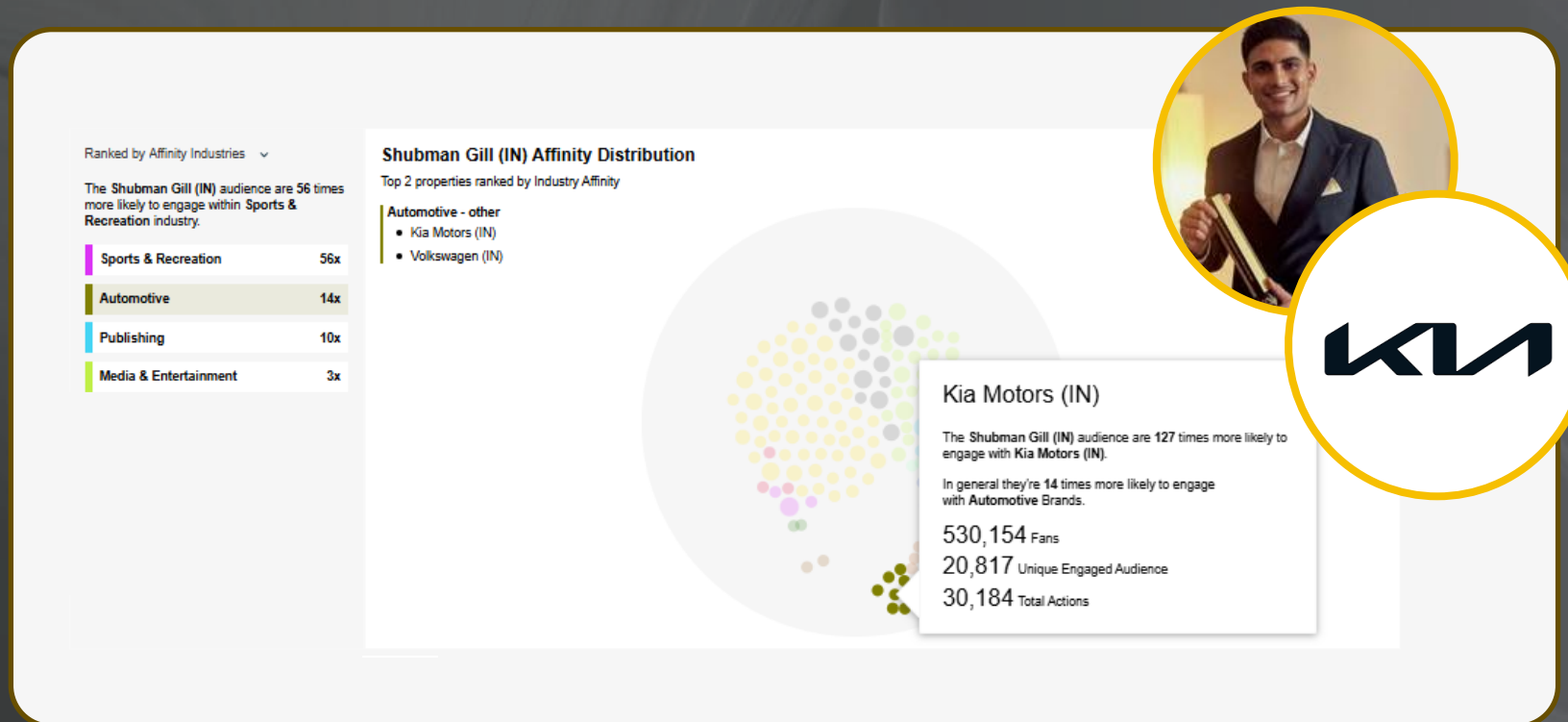
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How to Find the Partnership Your Social Media Strategy Needs

Shubman Gill's audience shows an affinity for the Automotive Industry, especially Kia.

Audience Affinity with Brands & Media



Brands and media turn to sport to reinforce their values and engage with fan communities.

Affinity is a key metric when identifying the **most suitable partnerships** for their strategies

When Sports Meets Stardom

Sports personalities teaming up with other fields' icons amplify reach and deepen audience connection.

Cross-fandom partnerships can deliver unmatched exposure, blending passion, lifestyle and performance into one powerful narrative.

Cricketer **Virat Kohli** and actress/producer **Anushka Sharma** are a cultural crossover example uniting sports and entertainment audiences.

Their combined influence turns their social posts into mainstream news, moving swiftly from social feeds to press headlines.



392.8M
Total followers



109.9M
Total followers



4.

Game-by-Game Insights

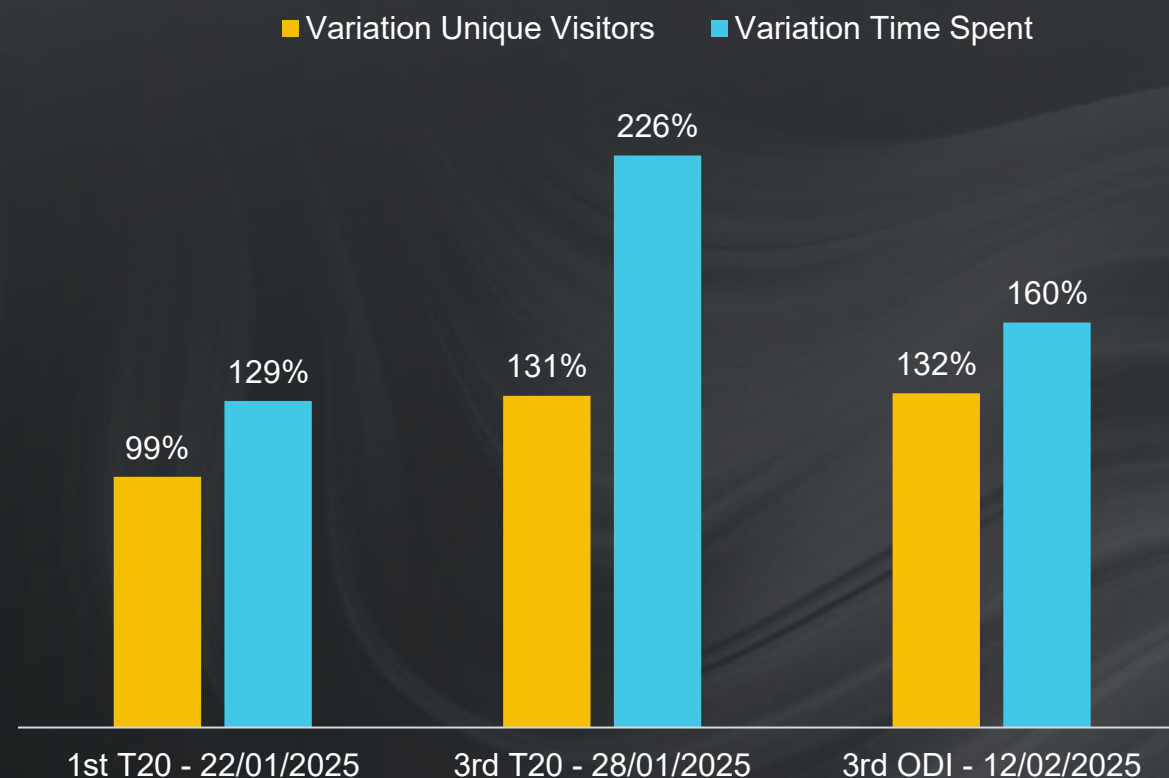
Cricket Snapshot:

International platform feels a significant shift in the mobile landscape on matchdays

On 22 January 2025, the day of the 1st T20 match between India and England, global media giants felt the impact. Hotstar.com's mobile audience in India nearly doubled to 27.4M, with time spent streaming up 129%. This was only the beginning, as the 3rd T20 and ODI match days also saw significant growth.

[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS MORE DATA POINTS ON THIS TOPIC](#)

Hotstar Mobile Audience and Time Spent Variance over Matchdays



American Football Snapshot:

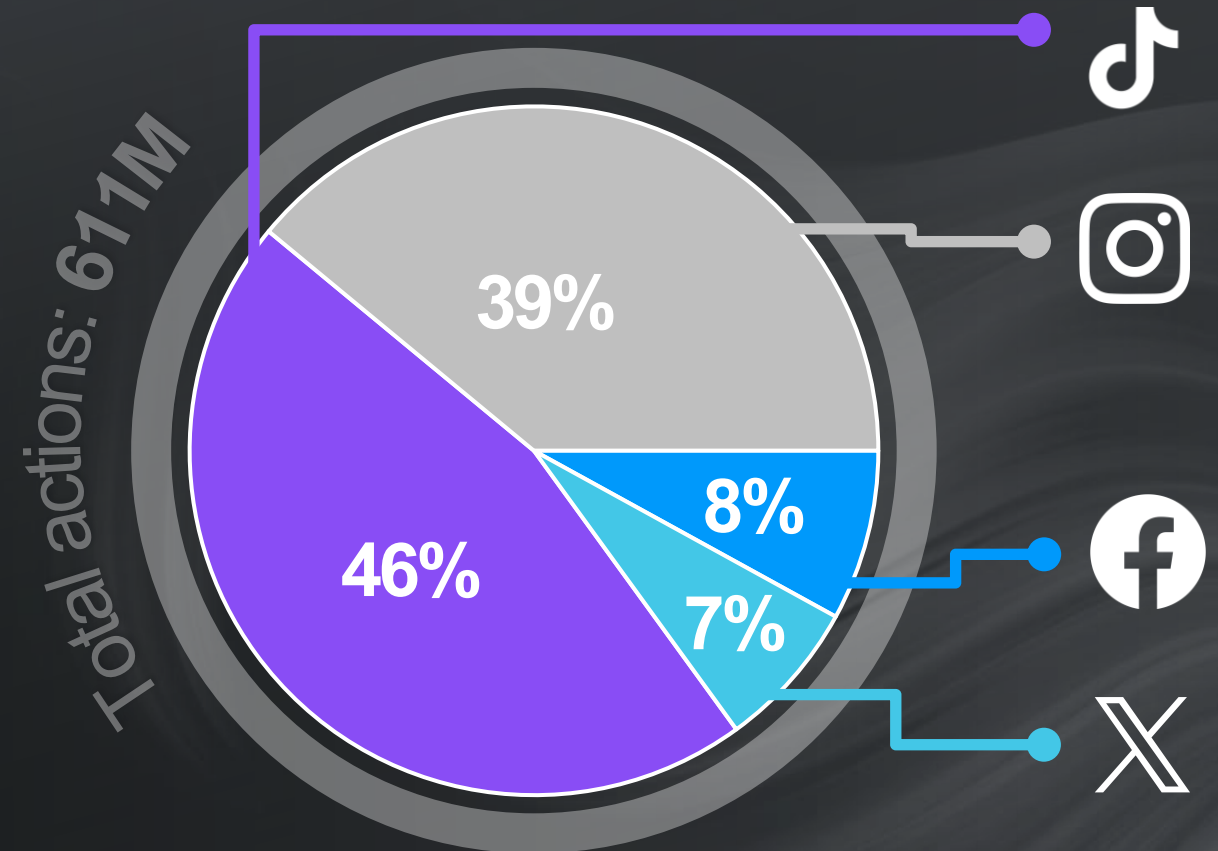
NFL Super Bowl or... “Social Bowl”?

The NFL’s biggest and most anticipated global sporting event, the Super Bowl, generated a social buzz of 611 million actions in 2025.

Among platforms, TikTok dominated the Big Game conversation, accounting for 46% of total engagement.

Social Engagement across Media, Brands and Influencers Related to Superbowl LIX

(February 8-10, 2025)



[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS MORE DATA POINTS ON THIS TOPIC](#)

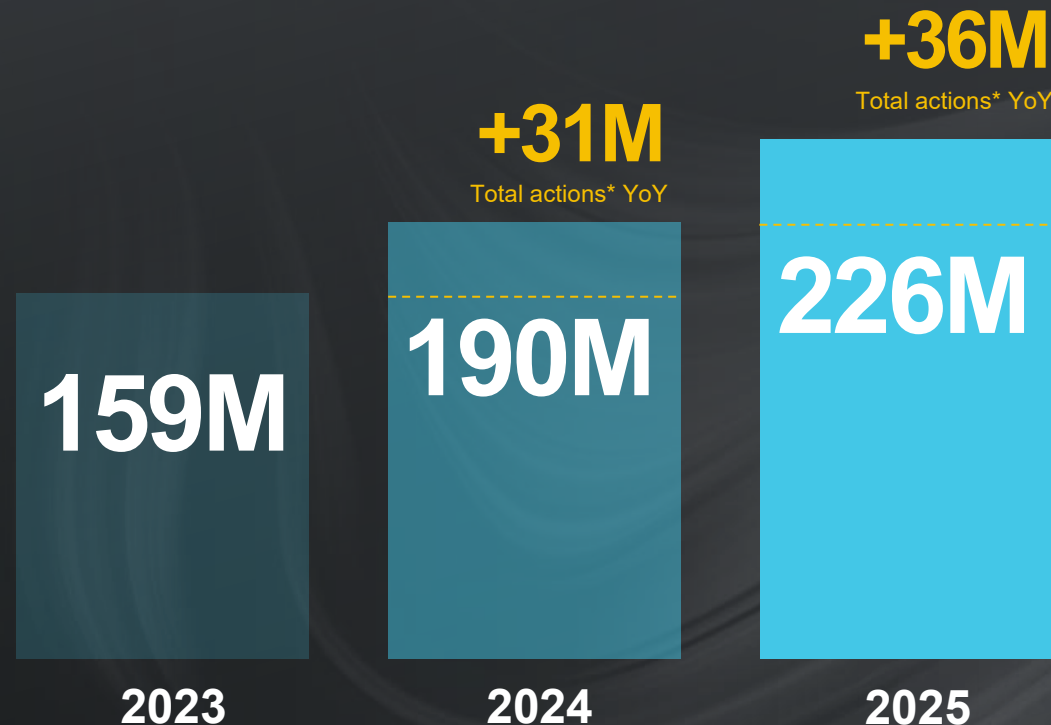
Tennis Snapshot:

Wimbledon 2025 engagement on social media marks a historic milestone

Posts across Facebook, Instagram, X, and TikTok mentioning the championship generated 226 million actions, the highest level ever recorded.

[CLICK HERE TO ACCESS MORE DATA POINTS ON THIS TOPIC](#)

Social Engagement Trend across Media, Brands and Influencers Mentioning “Wimbledon” During the Championships



Source: Comscore Social, Content Pulse, content mentioning “Wimbledon”, actions on Facebook, X, Instagram, and TikTok, Max. 5000 results, 2023: from June 26 to July 16, 2023 (Data extraction date: July 20, 2023), 2024: from June 24 to July 14, 2024 (Data extraction date: July 23, 2024), 2025: from June 30 to July 13, 2025 (Data extraction date: July 18, 2025).

Note: “Actions” refers to interactions including reactions, comments, shares, reposts, likes and hearts.

5.

2026 Opportunities & Key Takeaways

Get Ready for **2026 Sport Events** such as...

**Winter
Olympics
& Paralympics**



February 6–22 and March 6–15

Italy

**FIFA Men's
World Cup**



June 11–July 19

U.S., Canada & Mexico

**ICC Women's
T20 World Cup**



June 12–July 5

England & Wales

**F1
Madring
New Urban
Circuit**



September 11–16

Spain

Key Takeaways

1

A User-Centric Vision Requires Cross-Platform Measurement

Planning a strategy around a single channel fails to reflect the complexity of user behaviour. A deduplicated cross-platform measurement approach is essential to optimise campaign performance.

2

Understanding Audience Preferences Is Key to Connection

Audiences face an overwhelming volume of content. Identifying and deepening engagement around their preferences enables meaningful connections.

3

Social Media Is Not Just a Channel...It's the Arena!

Over half of sports content consumption now occurs on social platforms. Social media strategies are crucial to success in the digital sports ecosystem.

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India Edition